Verb-system cards

Tent cards for the words that orbit the verb: every form of *be*, *have* and *do*, the nine modals, *not* and the *n't* contractions, the semi-modals, the endings, and the *to* of *to go*. They are the size of the sentence cards, so they stand with its actors and actions.

In the set

Be 8	be am is are was were been being		
Have 4	have has had having	*Do* 5	do does did done doing
Modals 9	can could will would shall should may might must		
Contractions 16	isn't aren't wasn't weren't haven't hasn't hadn't don't doesn't didn't can't couldn't won't wouldn't shouldn't mustn't		
Not 2	not n't	*Semi-modals* 4	have to ought to going to used to
Endings 4	-s ed ing en	*To* 1	to

Blue moves, red stays

can move to the front to make a question — stays where it is

The band along the bottom of a card gives its colour. The *-s* and *ed* are blue because *do* carries them to the front: *she reads, does she read?* The *-s* of a plural, as in *books*, stays.

she	is	read	ing	.	→	is	she	read	ing	?
she	has	been	read	ing	.	→	has	she	been	read	ing	?
she	could	n't	read	.	→	could	n't	she	read	?
she	read	-s	.	→	does	she	read	?		
they	hop	p	ed	.	→	did	they	hop	?	
we	have to	read	.	→	do	we	have to	read	?	
he	is	going to	read	.	→	is	he	going to	read	?

Notes

N't goes where its operator goes: *Couldn't she read? Not* stays after the actor: *Could she not read?* The red apostrophe stands in for the *o* of *not*. *Can't* keeps one *n*, and *won't* and *don't* change the vowel. *Shan't* and *mightn't* are left out as rare.

The semi-modals mean what modals mean but don't move, so *do* comes to the front: *Do we have to read?*

Lay *ing*, *ed* or *en* over a final *e*: *write + ing*, *bake + ed*, *take + en*. After a short vowel, double the last letter first, with the sentence cards' extra *p* and *n*: *hop + p + ed*.

Print pages 2 to 10 in colour on card stock, single-sided, at actual size. Cut on the solid lines, fold on the dotted ones, and stand each card up.


bē


am


is


are


was


were

been



being



have



has



had



having




do


does


did


done


doing


can

could

will

would

shall

should

may

might

must

not

n't

isn't

aren't

wasn't



weren't



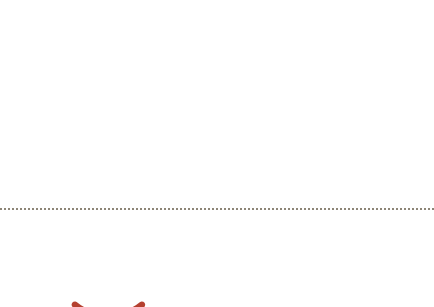
hăven't



hăsn't



hădn't



dōn't


doesn't


didn't

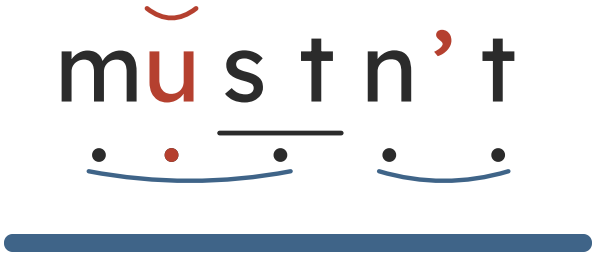

can't


couldn't


won't


wouldn't

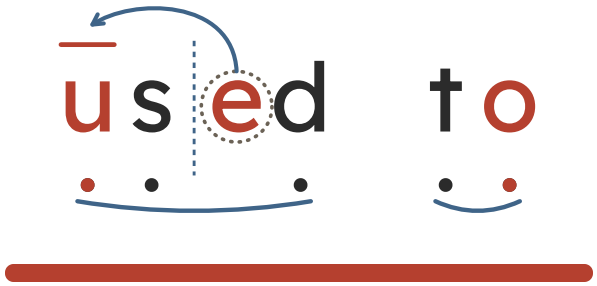

shouldn't


mŭstn't


hăve to


ought to


gŏing to


used to

-s



ed



ing



en



to

